

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 3

ARKANSAS
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arkansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

76

ARKANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 133 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 2, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
20 OF 75

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · ARKANSAS

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Arkansas. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Dianna Hewitt Ladd

JUDGE · SEBASTIAN COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Denied ex parte following arrest of my ex and cover up that denied me visitation"*

> *"Refused to hear our case ans a separate case from our moms and pushed it out."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/ar-dianna-hewitt-ladd/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARKANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 76 Arkansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
133
76 of 76 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$139,000
median across 32 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
24
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
36.8%
28 of 76 who answered; 18 of 76 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
76	1.8	76 of 76	20

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arkansas families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF ARKANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	45	$15,000	$76,851	$3,458,300
Lost Wages	35	$50,000	$231,677	$8,108,700
Other Court Fees	26	$2,850	$19,334	$502,685
Therapy / Evaluations	31	$5,000	$12,899	$399,875
Reunification Services	19	$100	$1,726	$32,800
GAL Fees	34	$2,500	$20,149	$685,050
Asset Loss [1]	25	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (32 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$139,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · ARKANSAS

Most families documenting in Arkansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	30	39%
Case closed: within last 2 years	15	20%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	15	20%
Not provided	9	12%
Not in court but still affected	4	5%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	32	42%
Both Family Court and CPS	32	42%
CPS Only	8	11%
Unknown	4	5%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	27	36%
Over 10 years	12	16%
5 – 10 years	12	16%
3 – 5 years	11	14%
Less than 6 months	7	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only	22	29%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access	17	22%
50/50 Joint	14	18%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)	10	13%
Full Custody	9	12%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Sebastian	12	20%
White	8	13%
Pulaski	8	13%
Lonoke	6	10%
Garland	4	7%
Boone	4	7%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	26	34%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	16	21%
High Conflict Divorce	13	17%
Other: (Short answer)	6	8%
Other	5	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — ARKANSAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Arkansas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *They illegally removed my children the kidnapped & sold my children to the foster family whom they never should have been sent to to begin with. My parents were signing guardianship papers when they were contacted & threatened by DHS that if tgey did nor pack my kids up & drive [...]*
>
> — DALLAS

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Arkansas allows parental kidnappings across state lines and dropping children off with open alcohol bottles in the car and is giving parents with past DUIs full custody and parents with clean records no due process.

— ARKANSAS PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM ARKANSAS

Wmy kids survived being abused for 12 years I am still unable to keep employment cause child support enforcement keeps my driver's licence

— HAMONN

Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

Kept me alienated for several years from my child, judges and attorneys let my abuser keep the control I was trying to escape with my child. Nobody cared.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Craighead County Circuit Court is full of court actors who only care about keeping you tied up in litigation. Judges do not care about the “best interest” of the children. They ignore patterns of abuse and coercive control.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Violated my constitutional rights, system is a scam and doesn’t care about the children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They gave my baby ro a drunk and a man who killed himself because he was messing with kids and he was gay

— LAURA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Ripped us apart, erased the God given fact that I gave birth to my son, utterly and completely destroyed the relationship between my only child and I. Made me out to be so.e ki d of criminal, crazy drug addict who was incapable of caring for her son.*
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> — ANGELA

American Family Court Genocide Has Killed My Family. American Veterans Children Matter!!

— AUBREY

Instead of protecting our family and those at risk, DCFS and the juvenile justice system has fractured our family. The trauma experienced doesn't just impact us but it will impact my nieces and their children and their children's children.

— TAMARA

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every [...]

— CHARISSA

Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

— KEVIN

Bankrupted us we lost our home, boats, vehicles sanity and caused grievance fir lost time with our grand children

— BRENDA

It has destroyed my family, my piece of mind, made me fear the police and DHS, permanently injured my spine, but exposed what happens In Arkansas.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Tore us apart my children need each other e there big sister her family she loves her family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was a mom for 14 years virtually all stay at home. No problems except on bio-dad's side. I made the mistake of trusting my sister in CA to help us "start over" and when she saw she couldn't take my children and her job was alerted to her scheme, she and husband joined bio-dad [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It hurts being ripped from my kids. My ex never wanted them. I was the only one raising them for 9 years he has had them for 2. Now I'm hearing he's abusing them and calling them worthless.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system originally made it to where I was only allowed to see my children every other weekend and on Tuesdays, giving the mother full control to manipulate the minds of my kids. The state changed from this to 50/50 custody as a standard during the 2nd filing for visitation [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took a loving parent and gave them to an abusive parent.

— NICKI

This is an America Family Genocide System!

— AUBREY

American Family Court Genocide Matters. Arkansas Hates Family And Has Destroyed Mine And Tried To Kill Us. I am a combat veteran..this family Court war....is worse than war in the Middle East.

— AUBREY

Him and the court has caused confusion with my children. Being alienated because your ex is beyond disgruntled and obsessed with destroying myself and my kids self esteem, security, and bond with their mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied under oath, broke my son's arm under care and still was able to adopt him, sent cruel messages and told me to sign my rights away

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have failed my son in every way possible including protecting him they removed based on false allegations and my other children miss their brother we want him located his safety verified and home where he is loved wanted missed and safe! I have everything ready and I'm so [...]

— AMY

I have four children in which one of my children is autistic level three nonverbal. He has not seen me in five months. I have not slept a good night sleep in over six months. I sleep for maybe two hours and I'm up for 22.

— BRITTANY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Due process violations, lost time with my kids , and being forced to spend money I don't have or be seperat d from my kids, along with being treated as a disposable parent are the inherent issues I have faced.*
>
> — MARVIN

The system cost us two years of my sister's life and our family can never get that time back. We went to court seeking justice, but the judge refused to hear our case, leaving us feeling powerless and unheard.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've been robbed of being a full-time mother for with both of my planned pregnancies, missing out on school milestones and participation in learning, as well as missing years of goodnight kisses, trust in the system, and being forced to abruptly stop breastfeeding as my child [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has tried to destroy me by its lies and what I believe to be illegal actions. It robbed my son and I from every milestone a teenager has. Mostly it has robbed us of our life. It has taken everything from the smallest Saturday morning hair, laughter, stories, experiences just [...]

— SANDRA

Lonoke Judge Parker should be reported and all his cases looked at by the law board. The whole court system in Lonoke County is ripping great loving mothers from thier children and allowing men to do anything they wish and make it a court order. How does he sleep at night.. on [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has torn my family apart my son's father has passed since this beginning of this and he didn't even get to grieve during this difficult time of loosing his dad which was his world

— STACEY

I have lost everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I dropped my kids off at school and they never got off the bus. I was met outside my home with handcuffs to be taken to interrogation room. My youngest had no mental health problems and now she deals with severe separation anxiety from me. My oldest struggles to fight the [...]

— JENESSA

The court ignored my daughter's statements of sexual abuse and awarded custody to her abuser. She has since experienced SI. The court refused to achknoedge violations of court order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Disregarded the laws and opened my eyes to realize the laws are seemingly made for civilians and not for government officials to follow. OR Do as I say, not as I do. They are judge and jury in a no jury, unlawful, overpowered bias system.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've been being sued my Dad/Stepmok since 2018-2026 for full custody of my two daughters he got temporary custody of them and has had that now for 13 months

— CHRISTINE

It didn't listen to me when I said he'll move far away and then take the girls. That he'll just keep coming at me until they are 18 when he can't make money off of them

— JESSICA

The Arkansas court system does not care about the best interests of the child. They have done whatever my ex wanted and are willing to hurt my child in order to retaliate against me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has been very insane the amount of families that are put through this that don't deserve it. They didn't give me a chance from the beginning offered no help but speedy court dates.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

40 Arkansas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ARKANSAS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Arkansas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> They illegally removed my children the kidnapped & sold my children to the foster family whom they never should have been sent to to begin with. My parents were signing guardianship papers when they were contacted & threatened by DHS that if tgey did nor pack my kids up & drive tgem to their office before 4 pm tgey were sending tge police to there home to arrest them & remove the children my parents had adopted & had been raising for years. When my parents got there tgey refused yo allow my children to leave with my parents & forced them to stay there & babysit my children while they called around in search of a foster placement that would take them all that night my parents had to leave to go get my kids dinner while babysitting them at the DHS office when that investigator had been speaking with NY mother daily & knew they were meeting with their attorney that day to sign guardianship papers bc I had a bad feeling they were going to do something crazy & illegally remove my children & we wouldn't be able to do anything about it or be able to find anyone to help us bc they were all involved in it together good ol boys scratching each other backs covering each other's ass & committing endless felonies against us violating every right we supposedly had. They stalked us harassed us illegally searched & seized two more newborns had our home surrounded by armed police officers our road blocked off by the us Marshall's had a roadblock set up questioning random drivers for information about us or the whereabouts of our newborn daughter when they had been told to leave us alone for 24 hours in order to allow us time for my parents to sign guardianship paperwork & have it filed
>
> — DALLAS (1/4)

> the following morning. That night the sheriff office surrounded my grandmother's home where I had left my newborn & mother to keep them safe they forced their way in handcuffed my mother & grandmother at 1230 midnight straight out of their sleep & did not have a signed court order or warrant & put my child in her car seat & illegally took her from my grandmother's home with no rights whatsoever & without her being in any immediate harm & after they had been ordered by the judge to stand down for 24 hrs. Then in Jan of 2018 they showed up to my house claiming they needed to do a welfare check on me & my 4 hrs old soon tgey weren't tgere to take him they just wanted to make sure we were ok & they would get out of our hair they were trespassing asked to leave our property about a million times tgey did not have a warrant or court order they pulled a gun on my husband who was outside while me & my son were in the house behind locked doors they threatened & scared my husband into calling me on my cell phone & telling me I nedded to unlock the door or they would kick it in. They stood around laughing joking sharing birth stories claimed all was good & they were just going to call their supervisor to inform him all was good & they would be on their way next thing you know they all enter my home stating that they are going to stay there with us until DHS got there. They illegally forced me to take a drug test in which I was unable to pee for due to dehydration & just having a baby & bleeding like crazy they claimed I refused marked it positive took my 4 hrs old child in below freezing temperatures then the following night in an attempt to cover their ass for all the illegal acts
>
> — DALLAS (2/4)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

they had committed the entire sheriff's office surrounded our house blocked off our road & proceeded to shot a fire bomb through our front door & kick in our front door ransack & destroy everything in our home drag my friend out in handcuffs 3 huge male officers enter my bathroom where I sm in my closet getting dressed bc I had just got out of the shower they claim I'm hiding locked in my closet start kicking the door in breaking the mirror on the outside when tgey can't kick it in the force it open even though it wasn't locked grab me by my hair forcefully rip me out of my closet in the process causing me to pee my pants & had blood gushing diwn my legs they are holding my arms & one is behind me shoving me in the head I have no shoes on & they drag me through all the broken glass I'm hysterical & screaming you are hurting me I just had a baby less than 24 hrs ago they kept telling shut the fuck up we don't give a fuck got me yo the porch shoved me to my knees then kicked me in the back yo force me down on my stomach then stopped me in the middle of my back once I was down. This act caused us to lose our section 8 be forced out of our house & lose about a half million worth of belongings of all types literally everything left our doors unlocked when they took my husband to jail on false charges & finally took me to the ER allowed our house & our shop to be robbed bc our door was left wide open our dog got out they were going to shoot him for trying to protect us. They destroyed our lives our children's lives stalked us harassed us caused us to lose everything & become homeless lose our jobs vehicles everything we had & had built for our family over the years lied

— DALLAS (3/4)

falsified police documents records didn't have warrants or court orders this story is endless its so long & corrupt & heartwrenching so many ppl should be in prison yet they are still free still have their jobs & completely got away with endless corrupt illegal acts they committed against us & our children

— DALLAS (4/4)

Wmy kids survived being abused for 12 years I am still unable to keep employment cause child support enforcement keeps my driver's licence

— HAMONN

Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every requirement and reunite with my children. When my children were taken, I immediately asked that they be placed with family members, but that request was refused. The department delayed setting up the counseling and support services that I was ordered to complete, even though I was ready and willing to participate. To make matters worse, they moved my children four hours away from me, knowing that I did not have a vehicle. This made it almost impossible to visit them regularly, no matter how much I wanted to. Throughout the process, I was portrayed inaccurately. In court, the department told the judge that I was not trying or cooperating, which was completely untrue. The Arkansas State Police later investigated the allegations that led to my children's removal and found them to be unfounded and untrue. Even with that finding, my children were never returned to my care. Eventually, I was pressured into signing away my parental rights — not because I wanted to, but because I was cornered and made to feel that I had no other choice. My children were adopted, and I live every day with the pain of knowing that the truth was ignored and that I did everything I could to bring them home. This experience has left me determined to speak up — for myself, for my children, and for other parents who are struggling to be heard and treated fairly.

— CHARISSA

Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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This system originally made it to where I was only allowed to see my children every other weekend and on Tuesdays, giving the mother full control to manipulate the minds of my kids. The state changed from this to 50/50 custody as a standard during the 2nd filing for visitation with my children. Because I have been successful at my job and constantly pushing to do better for my kids, I was told even with this aggreement I have to shoulder the burden of child support, insurance, and the mother gets to choose which school the children attend. To this day my children have said they would rather attend schools closer to me and hate that the mother and her family have continued to talk negatively about me. The court has made it almost impossible to hold her accountable and she uses this knowledge to continue to cause issues in my new marriage and relationship with the children. Decisions about custody were made because she had a majority of the custody time and the fact that my children were stripped from me during Christmas and held for 6 months was never factored into this. It was like it didn't matter. Watching the pain in my youngest child's face when it's the night before they return is horrible. I have fought for the betterment of my children and constantly told that because I'm the dad, the burden of proof is higher on me that she is doing wrong.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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40 full approved Arkansas comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arkansas report comes from Arkansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arkansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 76 Arkansas families reporting here are not the universe of Arkansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

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